Variance Form for Proposed Alternative Solution

This form, in its entirety including all supporting documentation, must be forwarded to:

Safety Codes Council
Administrator of Accreditation
500, 1405 Jasper Avenue NW
Edmonton, AB T5J 3N4

Email: accreditation@safetycodes.ab.ca

PART 1 – Applicant

All sections of Part 1 must be filled out in full by the **applicant** (owner and/or owner's representative) to request an alternative solution/variance to build, install, process or otherwise act in a manner that is not consistent with the provision of an applicable Code/Standard/Regulation.

Section A: Applicant Information

Owner's Name
Owner's Representative
Mailing Address
Date of Request

Section B: Details of Proposed Alternative Solution

☐ Check this box if the Proposed Alternative Solution is for a Jurisdiction and is not site-specific.

Permit Number (if applicable)		
Legal description of property that this variance will apply to:		
Municipal Address		
Alberta Township Survey (ATS)	Lot	Block
	Plan	QTR
	SEC	TWP
	RGE	MER

Section C: Justification That Proposed Alternative Solution Will Meet or Exceed Prescriptive Code/Standard Article

Applicable Code or Standard National Building Code - 2023 Alberta Edition (2nd printing), Division B

Attributions to Acceptable Solutions

Article(s)	Objective	Function	Intent statements
9.1.1.1.(1)	No table row	No table row	No row in the NBC(AE) attribution table. No NBC 2020 intent statement; Appendix C-1.

Section D: Supporting Documentation

Name of Supporting Documentation and Name of the Individual/Professional and/or Professional Organization Responsible

Signatures and Disclosures

The collection of personal information is authorized under section 4(c) of the Protection of Privacy Act. This personal information will be used to review and assess the variance application, including verifying information provided.

I understand that the information provided will be shared with the Safety Codes Council in accordance with the municipality's Quality Management System agreement. The following information may also be published on the Safety Codes Council website under section of the Protection of Privacy Act: permit number, municipality, issue date and completion date, permit type, project type, work class, address, description of the project, total square footage, and project value range. By checking this box, I acknowledge and agree to the described use of the information provided.

By signing below, the owner and/or owner's agent expressly acknowledges and agrees that the proposed alternative design, installation or process will provide an alternative that provides equal or better performance to the provisions of the Code, Standard, and/or regulation stated above.

☐ Yes

Owner's Signature	Date
OWNER'S NAME (PLEASE PRINT)	
Owner's Representative's Signature	Date
OWNER'S REPRESENTATIVE'S NAME (PLEASE PRINT)	

PART 2(a) – Acceptance of Proposed Alternative Solution

This portion to be completed by **Safety Codes Officer (SCO)** responsible for reviewing the variance form for proposed alternative solution and issuing/refusing the specific variance.

Section A: Reviewer Information

Date of Review	
Authority Having Jurisdiction	
Agency Reviewing the Proposed Variance (if applicable)	
Name of Safety Codes Officer Responsible for Reviewing the Variance	Discipline
	Certification Number
	Designation Number

Section B: Acceptance Of Proposed Alternative Solution

I have reviewed the terms of the proposed variance/alternative solution as provided in Part 1. Based on the submitted information, the proposed alternative solution will provide equal or better performance to the provisions of the Code, Standard, and/or regulation. A Variance is **issued.**

In issuing a Variance, the following conditions must also be met:

Safety Codes Officer Signature	Date

PART 2(b) – Refusal of Proposed Alternative Solution

This portion to be completed by **Safety Codes Officer (SCO)** responsible for reviewing the variance form for proposed alternative solution and refusing the specific variance.

Section A: Reviewer Information

Date of Review	
Authority Having Jurisdiction	
Agency Reviewing the Proposed Variance (if applicable)	
Name of Safety Codes Officer Responsible for Reviewing the Variance	Discipline
	Certification Number
	Designation Number

Section B: Acceptance Of Proposed Alternative Solution

I have reviewed the terms of the proposed variance/alternative solution as provided in Part 1. This Variance is refused for the following reasons (check all that apply):

Information provided in Part 1 is **incorrect.**

Information provided in Part 1 does **NOT** provide sufficient or complete information for SCO to determine if proposed alternative solutions will provide equal or better performance to the provisions of the Code, Standard, and/or regulation.

Based on information provided in Part 1, the proposed alternative solution(s) will **NOT** provide equal or better performance to the provisions of the Code, Standard, and/or regulation.

Additional rationale and reasons for refusal:

Safety Codes Officer Signature	Date

PART 3 – Option to Appeal Written Refusals

The applicant (owner and/or owner's representative) to whom this written Notice of Refusal for Specific Variance may appeal it to the Safety Codes Council in conformance with the Bylaws of the Council, **within 30 days** of the date the Written Notice was served in person.

Section A: Reviewer Information

A request for an Appeal shall:

- be in writing, in the form of the Council's Notice of Appeal and signed by the appellant,
- contain a copy of the Written Notice being appealed,
- contain a concise statement concerning the matter being appealed setting out the grounds for appeal,
- contain the name, address, telephone number, and email of the person appealing; and
- be accompanied by the appropriate fee set out in the Council fee schedule.

Note: If you have reached out to an Administrator and received a written decision, you are not able to pursue the Council appeal process with respect to this notice of refusal.

Section B: Contact

Request for an Appeal shall be made to:

Safety Codes Council
Coordinator of Appeals
500, 1405 Jasper Avenue NW
Edmonton, AB T5J 3N4

Telephone: 780-413-0099 toll free 1-888-413-0099
Email: appeals@safetycodes.ab.ca
Website: safetycodes.ab.ca/council-information/appeals

Part 4 – Appendix		
Category	**Code Reference**	**Article Text**
Division A — Definitions	**1.4.1.2. Defined Terms**	“Alternative solution” means a building design or construction method that differs from the acceptable solutions in Division B but achieves at least the same level of performance.
Division A — Compliance Framework	**1.2.1.1.(1)**	“Compliance with this Code shall be achieved by (a) complying with the acceptable solutions in Division B, or (b) using alternative solutions that will achieve at least the minimum level of performance required by Division B…”
	1.2.1.1.(3)	“Alternative solutions shall (a) achieve at least the same level of performance as the acceptable solutions, and (b) be assessed against the objectives and functional statements.”
	1.2.1.2.(1)	“Division B contains acceptable solutions that are deemed to satisfy the requirements of this Code when used in compliance with this Code.”
	1.2.1.3.(1)	“Where an alternative solution is used, the level of performance shall be determined in relation to the objectives and functional statements attributed to the acceptable solutions.”
Division C — Administrative Requirements	**2.2.1.2.(1) Variances**	“A variance may be issued where the authority having jurisdiction is satisfied that the proposed alternative provides approximately equivalent or greater safety performance.”
	2.2.2.1.(1) Information Required	“Information required to establish compliance with this Code shall be submitted in a form acceptable to the authority having jurisdiction.”
	2.2.3.1.(1) Documents and Drawings	“Drawings and specifications shall be submitted where required to show that the proposed work will conform to this Code.”
	2.2.2.5.(1) Review and Acceptance	“Where required, the authority having jurisdiction shall review and accept documents submitted to demonstrate compliance with this Code.”
	Section 2.3.1.1. Alternative Solutions	1) Documentation conforming to this Subsection shall be provided by the person requesting the use of an alternative solution to demonstrate that the proposed alternative solution complies with this Code. 2) The documentation referred to in Sentence (1) shall include a) a Code analysis outlining the analytical methods and rationales used to determine that a proposed alternative solution will achieve at least the level of performance required by Clause 1.2.1.1.(1)(b) of Division A, and b) information concerning any special maintenance or operational requirements, including any building component commissioning requirements, that are necessary for the alternative solution to achieve compliance with the Code after the building is constructed. 3) The Code analysis referred to in Clause (2)(a) shall identify the applicable objectives, functional statements and acceptable solutions, and any assumptions, limiting or restricting factors, testing procedures, engineering studies or building performance parameters that will support a Code compliance assessment. 4) The Code analysis referred to in Clause (2)(a) shall include information about the qualifications, experience and background of the person or persons taking responsibility for the design.

		5) The information provided under Sentence (3) shall be in sufficient detail to convey the design intent and to support the validity, accuracy, relevance and precision of the Code analysis. 6) Where the design of a building includes proposed alternative solutions that involve more than one person taking responsibility for different aspects of the design, the applicant for the permit shall identify a single person to co-ordinate the preparation of the design, Code analysis and documentation referred to in this Subsection.
	2.4.2.1.(1) Professional Design	“Where required, the design and field review shall be carried out by a registered professional skilled in the appropriate discipline.”
Safety Codes Act (Alberta)	**Variance Authority**	The authority having jurisdiction may issue a variance where a proposed alternative provides for equivalent or greater safety performance. (Legislative basis for alternative solutions in Alberta)
	Compliance Requirement	No person shall commence work unless it complies with the Act, the regulations, and the adopted codes.
Permit Regulation (Alberta)	**Permit Application Requirements**	An application for a permit shall include sufficient information to enable the authority having jurisdiction to determine whether the proposed work complies with the Act and the codes.
	Conditions of Permit	A permit may include conditions necessary to ensure compliance with the Act and the codes.

Appendix to the Variance Form for Proposed Alternative Solution

Case Egress window (case_da65cf70254b). Generated 2026-10-27 by Batatis with field map challenge_2026-09-15. Code references are to the National Building Code - 2023 Alberta Edition, 2nd printing (NBC(AE) 2023).

This package has two parts. The request for variance is the application under section 38 of the Safety Codes Act; a Safety Codes Officer decides whether to issue a variance. The alternative solution (NBC(AE) 2023 Division C 2.3.1) is the evidence the proponent supplies to show that the proposed design achieves at least the level of performance of the acceptable solution it replaces, in the areas defined by the objectives and functional statements attributed to it (Division A 1.2.1.1.(1)(b)). This appendix lists what the application cites and what the applicant wrote. It makes no finding about the design; the officer reviews it.

C. Attributions to acceptable solutions

Each row is a Division B acceptable solution the proposal departs from. Its objectives and functional statements come from the NBC(AE) 2023 attribution tables by lookup, not from a model.

Ref	Provision	How identified	Objectives	Functions
C-1	9.1.1.1.(1)	Listed by code identification; confirmed by the applicant.	no table row	no table row

Benchmark acceptable solution

Benchmark: NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14]

Quoted sentence: An egress window must open. NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14] https://nrc-publications.canada.ca/eng/view/ft/?id=0316d953-0d55-4311-af69-cad55efec499

Departure: Doors open 100 mm wider than the sentence allows, with a 900 mm clear width. (confirmed by the applicant)

C-1 9.1.1.1.(1)

Citation: NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14]

On the form: row 1

How this row was identified: Listed by code identification; confirmed by the applicant.

Identification quote (word for word in the code database): An egress window must open. NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14] https://nrc-publications.canada.ca/eng/view/ft/?id=0316d953-0d55-4311-af69-cad55efec499

Attribution status: no row in the attribution table

The NBC(AE) 2023 attribution table has no row for this provision, so no objective or functional statement is attributed to it here.

Provision text: Article 9.1.1.1.

> An egress window must open. NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14] https://nrc-publications.canada.ca/eng/view/ft/?id=0316d953-0d55-4311-af69-cad55efec499

NBC 2020 Intent Statements, explanatory only

No NBC 2020 intent statement was found for this provision.

Batatis administrative source record v1
These are recorded administrative statements. Credentials, authority and technical scope need human review.
Record type: professional declaration
Involvement: unresolved
Requirement: depends
Applicant confirmation: no
Name:
Role:
Basis: Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Owner:
Location:
Pathway: alternative
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: admin:jurisdiction
Section: B
Field: jurisdiction
Label: the reviewing jurisdiction
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: Your application appears to be missing the reviewing jurisdiction.
Fix: Ask which authority will receive the application.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:professional_law
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:design_scope
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(3) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(3) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(3) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(3) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:fire_alarm_unknown
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.4.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.4.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.4.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.4.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:suppression_unknown
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.3.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.3.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.3.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.3.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:part4_unknown
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.2.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.2.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.2.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.2.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:special_safety
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(4) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(4) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(4) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(4) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:source_lookup:general_unresolved
Section: D
Field: professional_source
Label: professional source
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: yes
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(1) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(1) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: professional:professional_requirement
Section: D
Field: professional_requirement
Label: professional requirement
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: blocking
Route: officer
Submission blocking: no
Message: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Fix: The citation lookup for Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) did not resolve. Ask the code reviewer to verify Division C 2.4.1.1.(5) before deciding this requirement. The officer decides.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: evidence_scope:evidence.ev_6621b3dfa5ffdc9e.scope
Section: D
Field: evidence.ev_6621b3dfa5ffdc9e.scope
Label: an identified performance benchmark for 9.1.1.1.(1)
Reason code: saved_constraint
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: Your application appears to be missing an identified performance benchmark for 9.1.1.1.(1).
Fix: The table has no row; ask the responsible designer which substantive benchmark applies.
Citation: NBC(AE) 2023 p2, Div B, Sentence 9.1.1.1.(1) [PDF p.14]
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: rationale:unanswered
Section: process
Field: rationale
Label: rationale
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No rationale was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: risk_assessment:unanswered
Section: process
Field: risk_assessment
Label: risk assessment
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No risk assessment was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: mitigating_measures:unanswered
Section: process
Field: mitigating_measures
Label: mitigating measures
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No mitigating measures was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: assumptions_and_limits:unanswered
Section: process
Field: assumptions_and_limits
Label: assumptions and limits
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No assumptions and limits was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: maintenance_operation:unanswered
Section: process
Field: maintenance_operation
Label: maintenance operation
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No maintenance operation was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: qualifications:unanswered
Section: process
Field: qualifications
Label: qualifications
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No qualifications was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record

Batatis administrative source record v1
Record type: unresolved input
Requirement key: scope:unanswered
Section: B
Field: scope
Label: scope
Reason code: blank
Severity: warning
Route: applicant
Submission blocking: yes
Message: No scope was supplied.
Fix: Supply this answer.
Citation:
End administrative source record